

Video Integration Guide for Nature's Way Soil Blog

Overview

The blog now supports automatic video display for social media promotion across TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube. Videos are displayed prominently at the top of blog articles when configured.

Video Fields in `blog_articles.json`

Each article in `public/blog_articles.json` now includes the following video-related fields:

```
{
  "videos": {
    "tiktok": null,
    "instagram": null,
    "youtube": null
  },
  "videoDescription": null,
  "socialMediaPromoted": false
}
```

Field Descriptions

- **videos.tiktok**: TikTok video URL or embed code
- **videos.instagram**: Instagram video URL or embed code
- **videos.youtube**: YouTube video URL or embed code
- **videoDescription**: Optional description text displayed above the videos
- **socialMediaPromoted**: Boolean flag - set to `true` to display videos on the article page

How to Add Videos to an Article

Step 1: Get Your Video Embed Code or URL

YouTube

1. Go to your YouTube video
2. Click "Share" → "Embed"
3. Copy either:
 - The full embed code: `<iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/VIDEO_ID" ...></iframe>`
 - Or just the URL: `https://www.youtube.com/embed/VIDEO_ID`

Example:

```
"youtube": "https://www.youtube.com/embed/dQw4w9WgXcQ"
```

TikTok

1. Go to your TikTok video
2. Click "Share" → "Embed"

3. Copy the embed code (includes `<blockquote>` tag)

Example:

```
"tiktok": "<blockquote class=\"tiktok-embed\" cite=\"https://www.tiktok.com/@username/video/1234567890\" data-video-id=\"1234567890\"><section></section></blockquote><script async src=\"https://www.tiktok.com/embed.js\"></script>"
```

Instagram

1. Go to your Instagram video post
2. Click “...” → “Embed”
3. Copy the embed code (includes `<blockquote>` tag)

Example:

```
"instagram": "<blockquote class=\"instagram-media\" data-instgrm-permalink=\"https://i.ytimg.com/vi/wk-0DKgFavM/hq720.jpg?sqp=-oaymwEhCK4FEIIDSFryq4qpAxMIARUAAAAAGAE-lAADIQj0AgKJD&rs=A0n4CLB4x2ZMXAPZHLnxnfkiHrFywika6Q\"><a href=\"https://i.ytimg.com/vi/bqIBZjHRBL4/hq720.jpg?sqp=-oaymwEhCK4FEIIDSFryq4qpAxMIARUAAAAAGAE-lAADIQj0AgKJD&rs=A0n4CLAdjN0Nw7Umw_JNly0p4f6Rp0mGkw\"></a></blockquote><script async src=\"//www.instagram.com/embed.js\"></script>"
```

Step 2: Update the Article in blog_articles.json

Edit `public/blog_articles.json` and update the article:

```
{
  "id": "article_20251001_123456",
  "slug": "pruning-techniques-healthier-plants",
  "title": "Pruning Techniques for Healthier Plants",
  "excerpt": "...",
  "content": "...",
  "publishDate": "2025-10-01T12:00:00.000Z",
  "category": "Plant Care",
  "featuredImage": "...",
  "author": "Nature's Way Team",
  "featuredPost": false,
  "videos": {
    "tiktok": "<blockquote class=\"tiktok-embed\"...></blockquote>",
    "instagram": "<blockquote class=\"instagram-media\"...></blockquote>",
    "youtube": "https://www.youtube.com/embed/VIDEO_ID"
  },
  "videoDescription": "Watch our expert demonstrate these pruning techniques in action! Available on YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram.",
  "socialMediaPromoted": true
}
```

Step 3: Commit and Push Changes

```
cd /home/ubuntu/github_repos/coplit-built
git add public/blog_articles.json
git commit -m "Add video integration for [article name]"
git push origin main
```

The website will automatically rebuild and display the videos on the article page.

Video Display Behavior

When Videos Are Shown

Videos are displayed when:

- `socialMediaPromoted` is set to `true`
- At least one video URL/embed code is provided (tiktok, instagram, or youtube)

Video Section Layout

- Videos appear at the top of the article, below the featured image and metadata
- Videos are displayed in a responsive grid layout
- Each platform has its own labeled container with platform icon
- On desktop: videos display side-by-side (up to 3 columns)
- On mobile: videos stack vertically

Styling Features

- Gradient background with green border matching brand colors
- Platform-specific icons (YouTube, TikTok, Instagram)
- Hover effects on video containers
- Responsive 16:9 aspect ratio for all videos
- Smooth animations and transitions

Example: Complete Article with Videos

```
{
  "id": "article_20251001_pruning",
  "slug": "pruning-techniques-healthier-plants",
  "title": "Pruning Techniques for Healthier Plants",
  "excerpt": "Master the art of pruning to promote healthier growth and abundant harvests in your garden.",
  "content": "# Pruning Techniques for Healthier Plants\n\n...",
  "publishDate": "2025-10-01T12:00:00.000Z",
  "category": "Plant Care",
  "featuredImage": "//images.unsplash.com/photo-1...",
  "author": "Nature's Way Team",
  "featuredPost": false,
  "videos": {
    "tiktok": "<blockquote class=\"tiktok-embed\" cite=\"https://www.tiktok.com/@natureswaysoil/video/1234567890\" data-video-id=\"1234567890\"><section></section></blockquote><script async src=\"https://www.tiktok.com/embed.js\"></script>",
    "instagram": "<blockquote class=\"instagram-media\" data-instgrm-permalink=\"https://i.ytimg.com/vi/DoxmmipH6Rc/maxresdefault.jpg\"><a href=\"https://i.ytimg.com/vi/PzQcyT7M0uo/hq720.jpg?sqp=-oaymwEhCK4FEIIDSFryq4qpAxMIARUAAAAAGAE-lAADIQj0AgKJD&rs=A0n4CLCHNW1PzwMinN5uRLiN01A0XF92-A\"></a></blockquote><script async src=\"https://www.instagram.com/embed.js\"></script>",
    "youtube": "https://www.youtube.com/embed/dQw4w9WgXcQ"
  },
  "videoDescription": "Watch our gardening expert demonstrate proper pruning techniques for different types of plants. Follow along on your favorite platform!",
  "socialMediaPromoted": true
}
```

Best Practices

Video Content

1. **Keep videos short and engaging** (30-90 seconds ideal for TikTok/Instagram)
2. **Create platform-specific versions** optimized for each platform's audience
3. **Include captions** for accessibility and silent viewing
4. **Match video content to article topic** for consistency

Video Description

1. **Be concise** - 1-2 sentences maximum
2. **Add value** - explain what viewers will learn
3. **Include call-to-action** - encourage engagement across platforms

Technical Considerations

1. **Test embed codes** before committing to ensure they work
2. **Use HTTPS URLs** for security
3. **Keep embed codes up-to-date** if platforms change their format
4. **Monitor video availability** - remove broken videos promptly

Troubleshooting

Videos Not Displaying

- Check that `socialMediaPromoted` is set to `true`
- Verify at least one video URL/embed code is provided
- Ensure embed codes are properly escaped in JSON
- Check browser console for JavaScript errors

Video Embed Issues

- **TikTok/Instagram:** Make sure to include the full embed code with `<script>` tag
- **YouTube:** Use the `/embed/` URL format, not the regular watch URL
- **Mixed Content:** Ensure all URLs use HTTPS (or protocol-relative `//`)

Styling Issues

- Clear browser cache if styles don't update
- Check that the blog template file was properly updated
- Verify CSS is not being overridden by other styles

Future Enhancements

Potential improvements for the video integration:

1. **Video thumbnails** - Display custom thumbnails before video loads
2. **Lazy loading** - Load videos only when scrolled into view
3. **Analytics tracking** - Track video views and engagement
4. **Playlist support** - Multiple videos per platform
5. **Auto-play options** - Configurable auto-play behavior
6. **Video transcripts** - Accessibility and SEO benefits

Support

For questions or issues with video integration:

- Check this guide first
 - Review the blog template code in `pages/blog/[slug].js`
 - Test changes locally before pushing to production
 - Contact the development team for technical support
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Last Updated: October 1, 2025

Version: 1.0